Six clues to count

The drops that did not fall.

Name _____ Date _____

All numbers are pretend. Draw, use tens and ones, or show your steps.

1. Little counts 38 dew drops on one leaf and 47 on another. How many drops are there altogether?

38 + 47 = _____

Show your thinking.

2. A spider web has 72 dew beads. After sunrise, 38 evaporate. How many beads remain?

72 − 38 = _____

Show your thinking.

3. A leaf has 28 drops. Then 17 more form, and later 19 evaporate. How many drops remain?

28 + 17 − 19 = _____

Show your thinking.

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4. Little draws 4 rows of dew beads with 6 beads in each row. How many beads does Little draw?

$4 \times 6 =$ _____

Show your thinking.

5. Little has drawn 27 drops and wants 60 in the notebook. How many more drops must Little draw?

$27 + ___ = 60$

Show your thinking.

6. Follow Little’s drawing command: add 5 drops each time. The counts are 12, 17, 22. What count comes next?

12, 17, 22, ___

Show your thinking.

WONDER DAILY

The drops that did not fall.

Little's instructions for dew



One leaf. Six steps. A story that keeps going.

GRADE 2

Make a little book.

1. Print one-sided: US Letter, portrait, actual size / 100%. No fit. Headers/footers off.
2. Fold long edge to long edge; reopen. Fold short edge to short edge, then in half again. Open: eight boxes.
3. Cut only the solid center line across the middle two boxes. Keep the outer boxes joined.
4. Refold long edge to long edge, print outside. Push ends together to open a diamond, then a cross.
5. Wrap into a book with page 1 in front. Follow pages 1 to 8.



Pictures are simplified and not to scale. Look closely, wonder, and pause whenever you like.

Your turn

Write one command sentence for the leaf's story. Tell what to do.

Example: First cool the leaf, then wait for tiny drops.

Wonder Daily 2

Before sunrise, Little Wonderer found tiny drops on a leaf. A spider web beside it wore shining beads. "Did I miss the rain?" Little asked. The path was dry. Big Wonderer knelt beside the leaf. "Let's follow the clues back through the night."



Wonder Daily 3

The night had been clear and calm. The leaf gave off heat to the open sky. It cooled and could get colder than the air around it. Little began a list of nature's instructions: "1. Cool the leaf." Nothing had fallen from the sky.



Wonder Daily 4

Air holds water vapor, water in a gas form we cannot see. Air touching the cool leaf cooled too. At the dew point, it was cool enough that it could not keep all its water invisible. Little added one: "2. Wait for the air to touch it."



Wonder Daily 5

Tiny drops formed right on the leaf. Water vapor had begun to condense: it changed from a gas into liquid water. That water was dew. The cool spider web held beads too. "3. Look for tiny drops," Little wrote. "They formed here. They did not fall like rain!"



Sunrise warmed the leaf. The beads grew smaller as water began to evaporate: it changed from liquid back into invisible vapor. Little added one last command: "4. Warm the leaf." The water was not gone forever. It had returned to the air. What would the next night bring?



Little checked the order: cool the leaf, let air touch it, then notice dew. "My commands are like a little program," Little said. "But nature does not read my notebook!" Big smiled. The instructions helped Little explain the changes, one step at a time.



Give the leaf an instruction.

The drops that did not fall. · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Choose one scene below. Write one command sentence for the leaf's story. You may add a second step.



The open night



Beads on a thread



Back into the air

Draw the leaf before or after your command. Add one label.

leaf · water vapor · condense · dew · evaporate · first · then

First, ... tell the leaf what to do before dew forms

Then, ... tell what to notice on the cool leaf

After sunrise, ... tell what to watch as the leaf warms

Read your sentence. Does it tell what to do, using a command such as Cool, Wait, Look, or Watch?